VECNA: EVE OF RUIN
COMPANION

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EVE OF RUIN COMPANION

Vecna: Eve of Ruin Companion presents alternatives to the narrative of said adventure.

These alternatives include everything from new events to changes to the adventure's plot to make it more coherent within the classic vision of the rules established for many of the Dungeons & Dragons settings.

This supplement is not intended to criticize or disparage the content of the adventure; however, many DMs and Players, especially those who follow the pre-established lore of the settings involved, may not agree with certain approaches presented in the official adventure.

Others may feel that the plot presented in the official adventure has certain inconsistencies and/or plot holes in.

Nevertheless, official adventures are usually presented in a format that requires the DM to make some personal adaptations to fill in gaps and/or make the adventure more suited to his playstyle and the events of his campaign.

It is with all these details in mind that this product seeks to present an alternative view of events, as well as filling these gaps, in order to facilitate the work of the Dungeon Masters.

Initially, the plots and events that may lead to changes on the part of the Dungeon Master will be addressed, both in relation to the settings involved and in the development of the adventure itself.

Afterwards, changes and plots will be suggested, chapter by chapter, with new possibilities for concluding the adventure.

POINTS THAT DIFFER FROM THE NATURE OF THE SETTINGS AND ALTERNATIVES

RAVENLOFT

DIVERGENT POINTS

The way the adventure is presented, the Dark Powers come into direct contact with Kas, informing him of Vecna's plan, freeing him from his imprisonment as a the Darklord of a domain and rewarding him with the Crown of Lies.

This approach goes against some of the basic principles of the classic Ravenloft setting. In the past, it was a consensus among authors that the Dark Powers would never be officially defined (including their own existence and identity never actually being confirmed).

Another point is that the Dark Powers never act directly, much less coming into direct contact with the inhabitants of the demiplane, even the Darklords.

ALTERNATIVE

It would be more coherent if the Dungeon Master changed this fact, ensuring that the Dark Powers never come into contact with Kas. As for the character, other approaches will also be offered later.

Note that here Ravenloft is being treated as a campaign setting, and not just in the Curse of Strahd approach.

FORGOTTEN REALMS

Although Vecna is not an influential or native character in the setting, the beginning of the adventure can be kept in the Forgotten Realms without major discrepancies, since the villain plans to alter the multiverse, which would include the Realms.

EBERRON

Nothing prevents the setting from being used in the adventure, however, within the complementary plots and ideas that we will be presented, other aspects of the setting will be covered in more depth.

SPELLJAMMER

The way the setting is used in the adventure does not require any major changes.

PLANESCAPE

DIVERGENT POINTS

It is known that Sigil can only be accessed through portals. The fact that Alustriel has created a form of access to her Sanctum and, even more so, as described in the adventure, the fact that the Lady of Pain ignores this detail, goes against one of the basic principles of the setting, that the Lady of Pain possesses supreme power in Sigil.

ALTERNATIVE

Remove the detail, making Alustriel's Sanctum just a location in Sigil, accessible only by those who are already in the planar metropolis by appropriate means.

ADVENTURE PLOT CHANGES

Next, controversial plot points and suggested changes will be addressed so that the events become more credible, impactful and convey all the urgency of an adventure whose purpose is to save the multiverse from destruction.

CONTROVERSIAL PLOT POINTS

VECNA

Vecna is (or should be) the main antagonist of the adventure. Therefore, his participation should be more active, not only placing him as a more tangible threat, but also making this threat clear to the Players and the entire multiverse.

The way it is originally used, little is known about the real threat that Vecna and his plan represent, either for the Players or for the multiverse as a whole.

The adventure takes place without a sense of urgency and without the multiverse realizing the risk it is taking.

Vecna's plan can also be improved. The fact that the god of secrets uses his cult to kidnap normal people in order to obtain secrets seems small, within the scope of his plan.

What would simple individuals in the Realms know that would be so important that it would allow Vecna to reshape the multiverse?

ALTERNATIVE

The alternative presented takes into account Vecna's history in previous editions.

Before becoming the god of secrets, Vecna was a demigod and one of the Darkords of Ravenloft. Having escaped at the end of the second edition, in the adventure "**Die, Vecna, Die!**" he invaded Sigil using the Mists of Ravenloft, and challenged the Lady of Pain, being defeated in the end.

The suggestion is that Vecna has learned the lesson that he will not be able to defeat the Lady of Pain, so his plan to reshape the multiverse must start from outside the planar metropolis.

In this sense, his plan would work as follows:

- **Vecna plans to utilize the Plane of Dreams (Dal Quor, in Eberron) in order to manifest his own dreams of what the multiverse would be like under his rule, and have those dreams take shape through the chaotic matter of Limbo and then mold the multiverse or create a new multiverse where he is sovereign;**
- **As a deity (or a lich), Vecna is not capable of dreaming. To do this, he needs someone to dream in his place;**
- **In order to obtain a dreamer, he uses an individual of great power (one of his cultists), allowing him access to his Hand and Eye;**
- **Dominated by the Hand and Eye of Vecna, the dreamer goes into a trance, and begins to dream about the multiverse recreated by the god of secrets;**
- **Kas would have been destroyed during Vecna's escape from Ravenloft in "Die, Vecna, Die!" (more details about Kas's role in the plot will be described later). However, the dreamer, having access to Vecna's mind, ends up touching his memories/fears, which causes Kas' memory to end up creating life and escaping Dal Quor, seeking revenge against his former master;**

- **During the adventure, the player characters would have contact with the dreamer's dreams, and consequently with the dream image of Vecna, which would be a way of placing the villain as a constant threatening presence in the adventure, and causing the multiverse to be tormented by its threat, as nightmares affect inhabitants of various worlds and planes of existence;**

- **Vecna takes the dreamer to Eberron, so that his dream begins to take shape in Dal Quor;**

- **In the end, Vecna would use the raw energy of the planes, in Limbo, to give shape to the dream of his multiverse, being able, at the Dungeon Master's discretion, to change the current multiverse according to his designs or create a new separate multiverse.**

KAS

During the Second Edition, Kas had also become one of the Darklords of Ravenloft. When Vecna escaped in "**Die, Vecna, Die!**", Kas's fate was left uncertain.

However, with the power acquired by the god of secrets, it makes sense to imagine that he has destroyed his enemy.

Here, as explained previously, Kas resurfaced through Vecna's memories of the dream realm and set out to seek revenge.

However, the plot presented in the official adventure involving Kas has certain points that seem unlikely, such as Kas impersonating Mordenkainen, without Alustriel and Tasha, however powerful they are, noticing. Furthermore, Mordenkainen himself is unaware of the danger the multiverse is in, while another individual takes his place.

ALTERNATIVE

- **One suggestion is that Kas not take on the role of Mordenkainen;**

- **After resurfacing in the material plane through Vecna's dreams, Kas sets out on a journey to find the Rod of Seven Parts, with the purpose of reviving Miska, the Wolf Spider to ruin Vecna´s creation;**

- **This version of Kas is indestructible as long as the dreamer is active. If he is defeated, some time later he will resurface from Vecna's dreams.**

THE REAL KAS

The Dungeon Master may wish to use the real Kas, rather than a version of the traitor created by Vecna's dreams. If so, Kas may have escaped from Ravenloft during the events of "**Die, Vecna, Die!**", and now roams the multiverse, seeing the events of the adventure as an opportunity to take revenge.

It could also be that there are two versions of Kas, the true one and the one created by Vecna's dreams. One possibility is that the real Kas absorbs his other version in order to obtain the knowledge from Vecna's mind and become more powerful to try to thwart his enemy's plans.

THE SWORD OF KAS

Assuming that the real Kas was destroyed, his sword may have suffered the same fate. However, the Sword of Kas manifested by Vecna's dreams ends up becoming real in the final chapters of the adventure, when the dreams become more powerful.

Alternatively, if the real Kas is alive and merges with his dream version, he will be in possession of his real sword.

MORDENKAINEN

A wizard with Mordenkainen's power would hardly let such a threat go unharmed. Especially with the balance of the multiverse at stake.

ALTERNATIVE

- **Here, the real Mordenkainen takes part in the events of the adventure.**

CHIME OF EXILE AND CROWN OF LIES

Among these suggestions, these artifacts will not be incorporated into the adventure plot.

The Crown of Lies, because Kas does not impersonate Mordenkainen, and the Chime of Exile, because its use, as described in the adventure, to banish Vecna to Oerth does not seem epic enough.

THE SECRETS

An alternative to using the secrets presented in the adventure is for the Dungeon Master to allow that for each secret that the characters discover, they receive an advantage against Vecna's dream manifestations or that for every two secrets discovered, Vecna's manifestations have 1 CR less (but never lesser than 10).

Keep in mind that the ideas presented do not need to be followed to the letter. The DM is encouraged to use and/or change whatever pleases him most, in order to shape the adventure according to his needs.

JUSTIFYING THE PLOT

To facilitate the dungeon Master's work, the plot events and their justifications will be summarized below.

- Vecna devises a plan to shape the multiverse in his image. This time, he does not intend to challenge the Lady of Pain, but rather to change the planes, leaving Sigil out (which in the end, would only provide access to his creation), to deal with this issue when he is sovereign of existence;

- After long planning, Vecna sends his servants after the Hand and the Eye, since not even he is able to know their location;

- The god of secrets discovers that his hand and eye are in the possession of individuals in Toril (Forgotten Realms), and sends his followers to obtain the artifacts, and attach them to one of his leader cultists (Chapter 1);

- The cultist, now known as “the dreamer”, is taken to Dal Quor, the plane of dreams of Eberron, where he will remain manifesting Vecna´s dream of the multiverse, linked to the god of secrets by his Hand and Eye;

- However, Vecna's dreams also manifest his subconscious. His memories and fears, including the trauma generated by Kas's betrayal, the danger posed by his sword and his visions of what could derail his plan. With this, Kas's projection ends up creating consciousness and escapes from Dal Quor, seeking to thwart Vecna's plans, fueled by the force of his own subconscious fear;

- Kas wishes to obtain the Rod of Seven Parts, as he knew from Vecna's subconscious that Miska would be one of the forces capable of corrupting his creation;

- The dreamer's dreams begin to manifest in the multiverse, causing nightmares among its inhabitants;

- In Eberron, the golden dragon Axackarvalos, a scholar of Draconic Prophecy, interprets an excerpt from the prophecy, warning of strange events in Dal Quor, and pointing out the player characters as figures who can prevent this event, as well as guiding him to the Sanctum in Sigil;

- As a precaution, Vecna included the most powerful individuals in the multiverse in his dream, where they are portrayed as weak beings unable to stop him;

- While the most powerful individuals in the multiverse end up being more affected by the nightmares, some going into a coma, others having their power reduced, Mordenkainen, Tasha and Alustriel manage to escape in time, taking refuge in the Sanctum, as the nightmares do not affect Sigil, since Vecna knows he is not capable of confronting the power of the Lady of Pain;

- Axackarvalos meets with the three archmages in the Sancrum and reveals the draconic prophecy to them. They perform the *Wish* spell in order to further discover a way to stop Vecna. Thus, Mordenkainen concludes that they will need the Sword of Kas. They also discover that Kas is in the Underdark of Faerûn in search of the Rod of Seven Parts;

- The archmages send the golden dragon to the party, which was not affected more severely, as Vecna ignores the threat they pose. Later the party is sent after Kas (Chapter 2). The vampire then decides to use the party to obtain the staff fragments in exchange for his sword;

- Kas intends for Vecna's dream to remain active for as long as possible, because the stronger and more real the dream becomes, the greater his power will be.

Changes to the plots will be presented ahead, covering chapter by chapter of the adventure, according to the options presented previously.

The ideas presented will probably require some adaptations and decisions on the part of the Dungeon Master, who will have certain paths to follow at his disposal. Also giving the player characters options to choose how to deal with the events, making the adventure less linear (or at least giving this impression) and perhaps even creating a race against time situation, which would convey all the urgency of an adventure where the multiverse is threatened.

CHAPTER 1

The adventure happens in the same way in this chapter, with the player characters in Faerûn, being hired to free individuals kidnapped by the cult of Vecna.

However, the secret that the cultists wanted to obtain from the victims was the whereabouts of the **Hand and Eye of Vecna** (since not even the god of secrets himself is capable of knowing the location of his lost parts), gathering information obtained by them (except , perhaps, Indrina).

Already in possession of the artifacts, the cultists fused it into one of their own. When the party arrives at the location, the ritual has just sent the cultist possessing the Hand and Eye to another plane, but the ritual is still active, with Eldon's vital energies and secrets being drained.

At this point, the events proceed normally as per **Vecna: Eve of Ruin**. At the end of the confrontation (in the situations specified in the adventure) the party is sent to Evernight, having to escape the place and return to Toril.

However, the secrets obtained by the player characters not only points them to Vecna, but also make them learn about the discovery and use of the Hand and the Eye, although they are not able to discover the whereabouts of the cultist who possesses the parts, nor what will be done with the artifacts.

CHAPTER 2

In this chapter, some significant changes will be made to the adventure's plot.

Vecna took the servant who attached the Hand and Eye to the plane of Dal Quor, in Eberron. In the dream plane, his servant, now possessed by part of the power and consciousness of the god of secrets, began to dream of the new multiverse.

As the dream takes shape, individuals across the multiverse become tormented by nightmares of a dark reality where Vecna is the supreme being.

However, Kas's memory ends up materializing and creating consciousness, escaping the realm of dreams, and going in search of revenge.

This is not the real Kas, but just a memory of him from Vecna´s mind. In short, the way Vecna imagines Kas: a treacherous individual, who wants to frustrate his plans with all his strength.

Because he emerged from Vecna's memories, Kas knows his plan, and knows his weaknesses and fears. He knows that if he frees Miska the Wolf-Spider, he could cause the creature of chaos to ruin his former master's creation.

With these events originating in Eberron, the dragons tried to find out what was going on, and one of them, the golden dragon Axackarvalos, ended up coming across an excerpt from the Draconic Prophecy. In his interpretation, a group of heroes from another world who came into contact with Vecna recently will be able to prevent the catastrophic events taking shape.

At the same time, Alustriel, Tasha and Mordenkainen head to Sigil, the only place in the multiverse where no one is affected by the terrible, maddening nightmares, taking refuge in Alustriel's Sanctum (which must be accessed by normal means after someone manages to enter the Cage).

Some time later, Axackarvalos finds a portal to Sigil, once again following the Draconic Prophecy. He takes on a human form and joins the archmages in the sanctum, telling them about the heroes of the prophecy.

The dragon explains to the archmages about his world, Dal Quor, the disturbing dreams originating there, and the threat they pose.

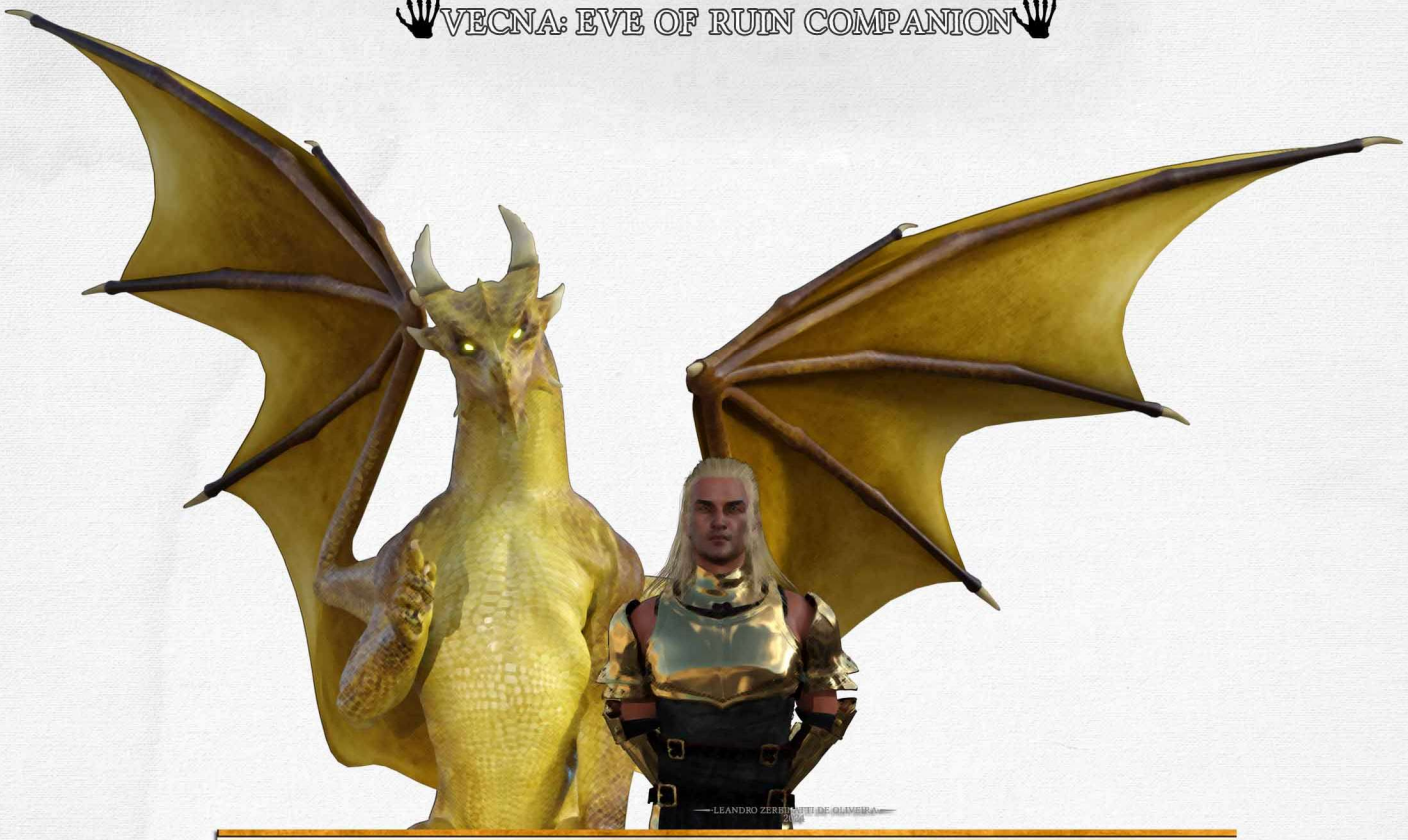
Mordenkainen, Alustriel and Tasha, accompanied by Axackarvalos, perform the ***Wish*** spell to try to understand what is happening, but are unable to locate Vecna's whereabouts. What they discover is that the nightmares affecting the multiverse are the work of the god of secrets and that Kas is back, trying to thwart his former master and in search of the Rod of Seven Parts.

Without further information, they choose to follow the Draconic Prophecy and send the golden dragon in search of the player characters.

The chapter begins some time after (how long exactly is up to the Dungeon Master's discretion) the events of Chapter 1.

Axackarvalos presents himself in human form to the player characters, explaining to them about the threat of Vecna and his relationship with the recent nightmares. If the player characters have any doubts about his intentions, he can reveal his true form, inviting them to Sigil to participate in a conference with the three archmages in the Sanctum.

At Alustriel's Sanctum, the trio of archmages question the player characters about their discoveries in the events of Chapter 1. If the party mentions the cultists' search for the Hand and the Eye, Mordenkainen will inform them that their concerns are, in fact, true. Vecna is



Axackarvalos - Adult Gold Dragon

Huge Dragon, lawful good

Armor Class 19 (natural armor)
Hit Points 256 (19d12 + 133)
Speed 40 ft., fly 80 ft., swim 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
27 (+8)	14 (+2)	25 (+7)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	24 (+7)

Saving Throws Dex +8, Con +13, Wis +9, Cha +13
Skills Insight +9, Perception +15, Persuasion +13, Stealth +8
Damage Immunities fire
Senses blindsight 60 ft., darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 25
Languages Common, Draconic
Challenge 17 (18,000 XP)

Amphibious. The dragon can breathe air and water.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If the dragon fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Actions

Multiattack. The dragon can use its Frightful Presence. It then makes three attacks: one with its bite and two with its claws.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +14 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 19 (2d10 + 8) piercing damage.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +14 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d6 + 8) slashing damage.

Tail. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +14 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 17 (2d8 + 8) bludgeoning damage.

Frightful Presence. Each creature of the dragon's choice that is within 120 feet of the dragon and aware of it must succeed on a DC 21 Wisdom saving throw or become frightened for 1 minute. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. If a creature's saving throw is successful or the effect ends for it, the creature is immune to the dragon's Frightful Presence for the next 24 hours.

Breath Weapons (Recharge 5-6). The dragon uses one of the following breath weapons.

Fire Breath. The dragon exhales fire in a 60-foot cone. Each creature in that area must make a DC 21 Dexterity saving throw, taking 66 (12d10) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

Weakening Breath. The dragon exhales gas in a 60-foot cone. Each creature in that area must succeed on a DC 21 Strength saving throw or have disadvantage on Strength-based attack rolls, Strength checks, and Strength saving throws for 1 minute. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

Change Shape. The dragon magically polymorphs into a humanoid or beast that has a challenge rating no higher than its own, or back into its true form. It reverts to its true form if it dies. Any equipment it is wearing or carrying is absorbed or borne by the new form (the dragon's choice).

In a new form, the dragon retains its alignment, hit points, Hit Dice, ability to speak, proficiencies, Legendary Resistance, lair actions, and Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma scores, as well as this action. Its statistics and capabilities are otherwise replaced by those of the new form, except any class features or legendary actions of that form.

Legendary Actions

The dragon can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The dragon regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Detect. The dragon makes a Wisdom (Perception) check.
Tail Attack. The dragon makes a tail attack.
Wing Attack (Costs 2 Actions). The dragon beats its wings. Each creature within 10 ft. of the dragon must succeed on a DC 22 Dexterity saving throw or take 15 (2d6 + 8) bludgeoning damage and be knocked prone. The dragon can then fly up to half its flying speed.

implementing a plan that affects the multiverse, and the nightmares are a consequence of this.

The golden dragon will then explain about his home world, Eberron, and the dream plane of Dal Quor. It will also reveal the player characters' role in stopping the god of secrets, according to the Draconic Prophecy.

The archmages explain that the Sword of Kas is of vital importance in defeating the possessor of the Hand and Eye, considering that it was this blade that defeated Vecna in the past.

Mordenkainen reveals his plan to confront Kas, looking for the sword. He knows that Kas is after the Rod of Seven Parts, and that the known whereabouts of one of the parts is the Underdark, where Kas has headed, according to the revelations obtained by the Wish spell.

Tasha, Alustriel and Mordenkainen will not accompany the party, as due to their power, they become much more susceptible to the nightmares caused by Vecna, and intend to remain safe in the Sanctum as a last contingency if everything else goes wrong.

The player characters may want to head straight for Eberron (and perhaps enter the plane of Dal Quor), but they are warned that without the Sword of Kas, they would hardly stand a chance against an enemy in possession of the Hand and Eye of Vecna.

The rest of the chapter plays out as described in the adventure, with the party exploring the Underdark in search of the first part of the rod. To do this, they are taken to a portal in Sigil, which leads directly to the correct location in the Underdark. Tasha, Alustriel, or Mordenkainen provide the portal key to the player characters.

Here, the Dungeon Master can follow two paths:

- **The party arrives before Kas. In this case, the vampire will arrive at the location once the party obtains the first part of the rod.**

- **The party arrives at the same time as Kas (or a few moments later). In this option, the player characters can confront Kas before beginning the search for the first part of the rod.**

CONFRONTING KAS

Whatever time the party encounters Kas (before or after they reach the first part of the rod), they will have to deal with the vampire.

For Kas, the presence of the player characters is a surprise, but not so unpleasant, since he starts to see them as pieces in his own plan, using his sword as a means of bargaining.

In their current situation, the party would hardly be able to defeat Kas. Moreover, even if they did, he would not be permanently destroyed, as he was a projection of Vecna's dream. In other words, even if he were defeated, he would simply be undone for a few moments, until he re-emerged from the dream to continue his search.

The most plausible option is for the party to dialogue with Kas. On this occasion, he will try to bargain, offering the sword as a reward if the party obtains the parts for the rod.

Kas knows Vecna's whereabouts, however, it is not in his interest that the ritual (especially the dream) be interrupted now, because the stronger Vecna's dream becomes (with its consequent materialization reforming the multiverse), the greater the chances of Kas's projection becomes fully real. Therefore, he will not reveal any further details to the player characters.

Furthermore, he will not bet on the player characters' success against Vecna, and will stick to his plan to obtain the rod to free Miska.

If the player characters make a bargain with Kas before starting the search for the first part of the rod, the vampire can accompany them.

Once the first part is obtained, Kas will leave the party to continue alone, while he grows stronger with the continuity of Vecna's dreams, while individuals in the multiverse begin to be increasingly severely affected by the nightmares of the new reality where the god of secrets is sovereign.

Note: Kas's sheet, as presented in the adventure, gives him more Intelligence than Vecna, which does not make sense. Therefore, the suggestion is that Kas's Intelligence attribute be changed to 20.

NEXT PARTS OF THE ROD

From here, other changes are suggested to the DM.

From **Chapters 3** to **8**, the player characters go to different locations in the multiverse in search of the other parts of the rod. However, the Dungeon Master does not need to follow the order of locations presented in the adventure. Technically this does not change much, but the important thing is that the Players be surprised by the places to explore, so that the journey does not seem linear.

The fragment in **Eberron (Chapter 4)** can be seen by the player characters as an opportunity to try to stop Vecna's dreamer in Dal Quor. While they have no chance of removing the cultist's Hand and Eye without the Sword of Kas, this intervention could be an opportunity to make Vecna more present in the adventure, creating his first direct interaction with the party.

Before heading towards each of the parts, it is suggested that the party must return to the Sanctum (using the same portal key that they used to reach the parts locations). They can take advantage of these occasions to report their discoveries to the three archmages and also to receive advice. Then, from Sigil, they will use the city's portals (with keys provided by the archmages) to reach different destinations in the multiverse.

If the Dungeon Master wishes to make the adventure more intense, he can develop a time limit for the parte to resolve the situation, before the multiverse changes definitively. Throughout the adventure (each chapter), effects of this change will begin to appear, however, the Dungeon Master can accelerate the appearance of these effects, according to the party's delay in searching for each part of the rod.

CHAPTER 3

This chapter does not need any drastic changes.

The only suggestion is that the player characters enter the Astral Plane through a portal in Sigil (and not in the Sanctum), and return to the city of portals through the same route, after obtaining the part.

CHAPTER 4

In this chapter, the player characters go to the continent of **Khorvaire**, in **Eberron**, in order to obtain another part, located in the **Mournlands**.

Before heading to Eberron, the player characters will receive advice from Axackarvalos about his home world. The dragon can give details about the Mournlands and Dal Quor (or he can leave information about the plane of dreams until the player characters have the Sword of Kas).

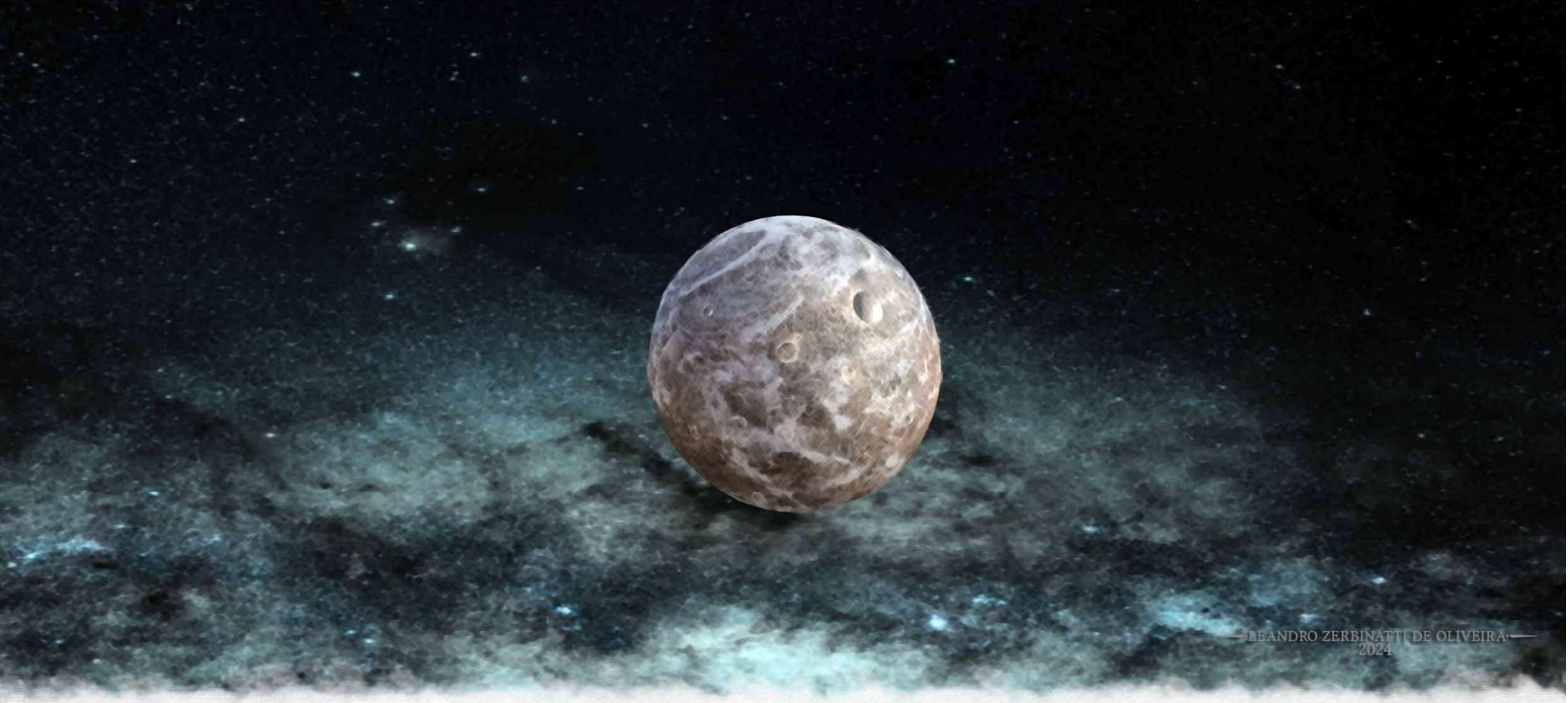
The **Quori** do not oppose Vecna, since it is their desire to turn reality into a great nightmare, and Vecna is in a way doing this.

The search for the rod piece continues in the same way as described in chapter 4 of **Vecna: Eve of Ruin.**

ADDITIONAL EVENTS

The player characters may want to enter **Dal Quor** and stop Vecna's dreamer before obtaining the Sword of Kas. At the DM's discretion, Axackarvalos may reveal the means to access the plane of dreams, or he may refuse to do so until the party is better prepared.

If the player characters wish to follow to **Dal Quor** on their own, they will have to do so in Khorvaire (since at this point the golden dragon will not reveal the key, nor the location of the portal in Sigil that allows access to such a plane). The possible means of access would be on the empire of **Riedra** in the continent of **Sarlona**, or through the knowledge of some **Quori**.



Another option would be portals in Khorvaire. It is known that the connection between the plane of dreams of Dal Quor and the material plane was severed long ago. However, Vecna remade this connection.

Each moon of Eberron is linked to one of that world's planes of existence. Since in ancient times the moon representing Dal Quor, **Crya**, was theoretically destroyed by the giants, the plane could no longer be accessed by physical means. Vecna, however, used his power to recreate the moon, allowing connection with Dal Quor again.

If the player characters manage to find one of these passages and cross over, they will be drawn directly to the point where the dreamer is, as the event created a vortex of dream energy in the plane.

Without the Sword of Kas, any type of attack carried out against the dreamer will be useless. Furthermore, the party will be constantly attacked by the Quori, creatures from nightmares, as well as a weaker projection of Vecna himself. The god of secrets will also be able to manipulate the player characters' own secrets in the form of nightmares against them.

In short, the player characters will be completely powerless against the dreamer at this point, and their only alternative would be to go back and continue the search for the parts of the rod to exchange for the Sword of Kas.

Regardless of whether the player characters enter Dal Quor without the Sword of Kas, Vecna will be aware of their intrusion, as he is the god of secrets. As his ritual continues and his dream becomes more tangible, he starts sending projections of himself in order to threaten the player characters. These projections may be mere visions intended to try to intimidate the party.

CHAPTER 5

Once again, the party enters the multiverse location through one of the portals in Sigil.

However, this time they will go to the **Demiplane of Dread**, **Ravenloft**. Entering the place is easy; however, leaving is not so simple.

Therefore, the first suggested modifications regarding this stage concern how the player characters will be able to leave the Demiplane of Dread after obtaining the fragment.

Mordenkainen can explain the nature of the location to the party, advising them to enlist the aid of a **Vistani** caravan to leave the mists. In this case, the Vistani will demand some payment from the party, which may consist of a favor, or some magical item. This is an opportunity for the DM to expand the adventure by placing additional events in **Ravenloft** so that the player characters can finally leave the mists.

Another suggested change concerns the cult of Osybus. This religion was introduced in the 5th edition of the setting, but it is not part of the classic Ravenloft lore. The issue is that the cult, as presented, tries, in a way, to define the Dark Powers, citing Osybus as one of them. Also being placed as responsible for Strahd's corruption.

This definition may not please those who follow the definitions of the classic setting. Therefore, if this is the case, the suggestion is that the cult of Osybus is replaced by vampires from **Kargat**, the secret police of **Azalin** (Darklord of Darkon, in the classic version), who found the staff part in Barovia and took refuge in Death House.

Another option is that it is the cult of **Erlin**, a death god from the ancient domain of Gundarak, annexed by Barovia. The cultists, separatists from Gundarak, would have found the rod part and taken it to Death House, in an attempt to plot a coup against Strahd.

Sarusanda could be fitted here as someone seeking revenge against Kargat agents or the cult of Erlin. It is even possible that the DM simply places Sarusanda's father, Galias, as one of the members of the Kargat or the cult of Erlin. In this case, she could belong to the **Keepers of the Black Feather**, a society that opposes Strahd, or the **Cult of the Morninglord**, a benign religion, and be a hero who aims to protect Barovia from the forces of darkness.

Ultimately, **Strahd's** presence could be justified in that he found out about the powerful artifact in his lands, in the hands of enemies, and now intends to obtain it, believing that its power will allow him to find the recent reincarnation of his beloved Tatyana.

If the player characters defeat Strahd, he will flee towards Castle Ravenloft and close the edges of his domain with a poisonous mist. As previously suggested, the party will have to enlist the help of the Vistani to escape the Demiplane of Dread before Strahd regains his strength.

Another alternative is for the party to be able to convince Strahd of the risk that the multiverse is suffering (in this case, it would be of no use to find Tatyana, if Vecna triumphed), or that the rod does not serve his purposes. However, even in this case, the party will still need the assistance of the Vistani to leave the Land of Mists.

For more in-depth information about the domain of Barovia, Strahd and the cults and secret societies mentioned in the suggestions, according to the lore of previous editions, we recommend the book "**Weathermay's Survival Guide to the Mists**" available at the **DMs Guild**.

LEANDRO ZERBINATTI DE OLIVEIRA·
2024

CHAPTER 6

There are no changes suggested for this chapter, considering that the antagonists involved do not have any significant relationship with Vecna or Kas.

However, **Krynn** may be affected more severely by the nightmares or even the first alterations in reality (**such as the lycanthropes**), depending on when the party travels to the world, if the Dungeon Master is using the option to make nightmares more powerful according to the passage of time. This idea can also be used in other chapters; depending on the order of the settings followed (more details about the effects of Vecna's ritual will be discussed later).

CHAPTER 7

This chapter does not require any drastic changes. Although **Oerth**, as it is the home world of Vecna and Kas, can count on the presence of cultists of the god of secrets trying to stop the party (since at this stage, Vecna will probably already be aware of the actions of the player characters).

Oerth may also be affected by nightmares and changes in reality in a more severe way, depending on when the party travels to the world, if the Dungeon Master is using the option to make the effects of the ritual more powerful according to the passage of the time.

CHAPTER 8

The adventure offers a plausible justification within the lore of Avernus for the existence of the casino, with it being part of Tiamat's territory and, therefore, being apart of the devastation caused by the Blood War.

The only suggestion would be, if the DM wishes to make Avernus more threatening, to intensify the events of the Blood War there.

Furthermore, if this is the last fragment in the order determined by the Dungeon Master, at that moment Vecna's dream will already be tangible, starting to affect the reality of the multiverse. Avernus will feature statues of Vecna, hordes of undead loyal to the god of secrets facing the armies of the Blood War and even new types of fiends loyal to Vecna will have manifested there.

CHAPTER 9

The events of this chapter are drastically changed in relation to what is presented in the adventure, since here the real Mordenkainen is in the Sanctum and Kas never assumed his identity.

Sigil is the only place in the multiverse that does not suffer the changes caused by Vecna's dream. All other locations present changes, slowly taking the form of the multiverse idealized by the god of secrets.

Powerful individuals from the multiverse become weak and powerless in the face of threat, as Vecna sees them as submissive to his power. Therefore, the trio of archmages will not leave the Sanctum.

The party does not suffer such effects if they leave Sigil, as Vecna was unaware of their existence and consequently did not include them in the dreams projected by the dreamer, which makes the player characters the only hope to stop the ritual.

When the party returns to the Sanctum, they are informed of a message left by Kas, summoning them to Pandemonium, in order **to exchange the Rod of Seven Parts for the Sword of Kas.**

The party can reach the exact location through one of Sigil's many portals, receiving the key from one of the archmages.

Axackarvalos will await their return in order to guide them to Dal Quor once they obtain the sword.

CHAPTER 10

Kas, now almost part of existence, since Vecna's dream has almost become reality, awaits the party.

The vampire is no fool, so he prepared an arcane contract to exchange the artifacts, imagining that the party might want to prevent him from keeping the rod after receiving the sword.

Kas meets the party at the entrance to **Carapace Ridge**, carrying his sword. He throws the scroll with the arcane contract towards the player characters, informing that with the contract signed with the blood of both parties, the exchange will be carried out, so that the rod will remain in his possession and the sword in the party's possession, until than the termination or interruption of the Vecna ritual. His signature is already on the contract.

An **Arcana skill check (DC 10)** reveals that the contract does not contain any dishonest clauses.

If the player characters sign, the exchange will take place. Otherwise, Kas will confront them for the rod. Remembering that as he is still a dream creation, the vampire can return if destroyed.

Once the exchange has taken place, Kas informs the party that Vecna is in **Limbo**, on an island created by his own will, performing the ritual to recreate the multiverse according to his designs using the power of his dreams to shape the primordial chaos.

He also informs the party that **the dreamer, the cultist carrying Vecna's Hand and Eye, is the one who projects the dreams from the plane of Dal Quor in Eberron**, and that separating the **Hand and Eye of Vecna** from the cultist will make the dreams cease.

At that moment, Vecna can send a projection of himself (with the CR of Vecna's sheet reduced by half), in order to try to stop the party and Kas, or he can simply appear on the horizon, through a threatening projection, warning the player characters to not interfere with his goals.

After that, Kas will set out to free Miska (something he will not reveal to the player characters, but they can try to find out with divination spells).

The party can return to the Sanctum and head to Dal Quor after Axackarvalos's final instructions, or they can try to follow Kas and try to stop him.

KAS OBJECTIVE

If Kas is not bothered or stopped by the party (**remembering that he can reform as long as the dreamer is not separated from the Hand and Eye of Vecna**), he will reach Miska's prison.

The vampire, however, does not simply intend to free the Wolf-Spider and leave him free as he pleases. He will use the Rod of Seven Parts to remove Miska from his prison and merge him with his essence. With this, he will pursue the following objectives:

1- **Try to usurp Vecna's multiverse and shape it to his designs;**

2- **If his first objective is not possible, as a final insult to Vecna, he will use the stick to merge Miska's essence into Vecna's new multiverse, ensuring that the god of secrets will never be able to completely control his chaos-tainted creation.**

If the party tries to go after Kas, the DM can use the rest of the chapter as presented in the adventure as the basis for the events.

EXTRA ADVENTURE STAGE: THE SHOWDOWN AT DAL QUOR

Before the final confrontation against Vecna, the party must head to Dal Quor, after briefly returning to the Sanctum. There, Axackarvalos will explain the nature of Dal Quor (if the party has not already gone there). He also offers to accompany the player characters on this journey.

The archmages have spent the party's recent absence using all of their resources to gain a deeper understanding of Vecna's plans, and when player characters return with the Sword of Kas they will share the following information with them:

- **Removing the Hand and Eye of Vecna from the dreamer in Dal Quor will make it possible to interrupt his ritual, otherwise the multiverse will remain in alteration until reality is completely altered, since at the current moment the ritual is already in an advanced state;**

- **Even with the removal of the Hand and the Eye, it will still be necessary to prevent the other stage of the ritual carried out by Vecna in Limbo. In other words, both stages must be interrupted;**

- **The Hand and Eye of Vecna can be used to reverse Vecna's ritual after his defeat, returning the multiverse to its previous state.**

After the meeting, the party will be taken to Dal Quor. Access to the plane of dreams of Eberron can be done physically, or more quickly, through one of the Sigil´s portals, for which the golden dragon has already obtained the key (which can consist of the player characters falling asleep under an arch in one of the alleys of the City of Portals).

Dal Quor is the plane of dreams. The plane shifts between two phases throughout the ages: the age of dreams and the age of nightmares. Currently (the equivalent of many eons on the material plane), Dal Quor is in the age of nightmares. Which means that its inhabitants, the Quori, take on the appearance and mentality of nightmares, completely forgetting what they were like and what the plane was like in the dream era.

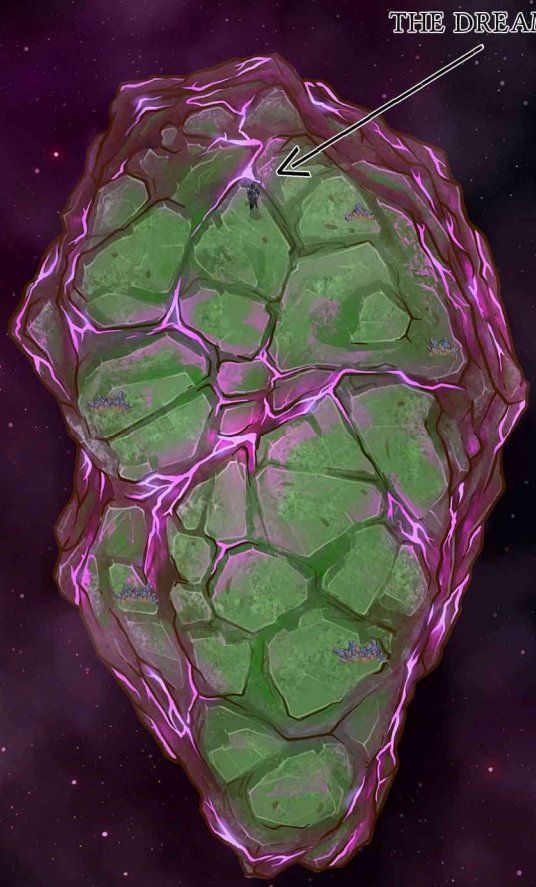
Therefore, those who enter Dal Quor are plagued by nightmares, manifested both by the natives of the plane and by the place itself, which materializes such visions, in addition to influencing the minds of visitors.

However, the presence of the dreamer caused this effect to be temporarily suspended, since the matter of dreams was completely channeled onto his person.

Now, the dreamer remains on a portion of land, created by his mind, dreaming Vecna's

VECNA: EVE OF RUIN COMPANION

DAL QUOR
VORTEX OF DREAMS



reality and sending this dream throughout the multiverse, while Vecna channels this energy into the plane of **Limbo** and merges it with the other planes of existence, altering them.

When the player characters arrive, they will be able to see the center of the dream vortex in the distance. A rock exuding dream energy, around which Vecna's dreams manifest in a whirlwind, before spreading across the planes. At the edge of the structure, the dreamer lies inert, with the Hand and Eye of Vecna attached to him.

The player characters move mentally until they reach the rock.

Although the dreamer offers no resistance, he is not alone. At the DM's discretion (and depending on the challenge he wishes to offer the Players), a group of Vecna cultists will be guarding the location (use the cultists' statistics from **Chapter 1**, adjusting the CR according to the party's level), Vecna can also create his projections to try to stop the party (the number of which can vary between one or more, at the Dungeon Master's discretion, recommending that these projections be based on Vecna's sheet, with the CR reduced by half, or enough to offer a balanced challenge to the party, but never with Vecna's full power).

As already mentioned, Vecna can use the player character's secrets or nightmare projections to try to torment them. Additionally, the party will get glimpses of images of the multiverse that Vecna intends to create.

Once the guardians of the place are defeated, the dreamer will be vulnerable. **With the Sword of Kas, in a simple action, the player characters will be able to separate the cultist's Hand and Eye.**

If the cultist is killed with the Sword of Kas, without the artifacts being first removed, the act will cause the destruction of the artifacts. This is a temporary destruction, but it will prevent the artifacts from being used later to reverse the effects of Vecna's ritual. Here, the DM can use the golden dragon's advice, warning the party about this risk.

Once the Hand and Eye are removed, and with the dreamer's death, the dream vortex of Dal Quor dissolves and the player characters are thrown back to Eberron or Sigil (whichever the DM prefers). It is up to them to decide what to do with the Hand and the Eye before heading to Limbo.

They can simply carry the artifacts with them, leaving them to be used only after Vecna is defeated, or they can attach them right away. If none of the player characters wish to take the risk of attaching the Hand and Eye of Vecna to his body, Axackarvalos will volunteer for the task, assuming his human form. The golden dragon is resolute enough to resist corruption, at least for as long as necessary.

Leaving for the final confrontation, the party heads to Limbo, through a portal in Sigil or the gatetown of Xaos.

VISIONS OF VECNA´S MULTIVERSE

Mages must pay tribute through sacrifices and dark arcane rituals.

All magic emanates from Vecna, as the chosen one of the Serpent. All magic becomes corrupted, and magic users who attempt to avoid this path are deemed unworthy and sent to planes of existence of suffering and punishment,

Individuals who are born without magic are considered unworthy and used by others as sacrifices or victims of rituals.

The good planes collapses and, with the exception of the planes that Vecna uses to torment his victims, all other planes of existence become evil, reflecting Vecna's ego.

The gods perish, and their remains floats in the Astral Plane.

The souls of the dead become undead under Vecna's command, or are used by him to gain more and more power.

He becomes the sole god of the worlds of the material plane, which are shaped to reflect his greatness and dominion. The places that do not become great cemeteries and empires of Vecna-worshipping undead become magocracies, ruled by cruel individuals, devoted to increasing Vecna's power and developing new evil spells.

Vecna roams these worlds mercilessly massacring the innocent as a way of boosting his own ego.

New demonic and undead beings emerge, as Vecna experiments exercising his creative power.

CHAPTER 11

This chapter will be presented differently from how it occurs in the adventure. Instead of the confrontation with Vecna taking place in Pandemonium, it will happen in **Limbo**, as it seems much more logical for Vecna to use the primordial chaos of that plane as raw material for the new reality.

The god of secrets, through his will, created an island in the middle of the chaos of Limbo. The site features a skull-shaped construction, reminiscent of the citadel of Cavitius.

From within the stone jaw, Vecna performs his ritual, channeling the form of his dreams into the raw chaos and merging that energy with the essence of the planes. Surrounding the island is a group of cultists, as well as any other guardians the DM wishes to include (they can be inspired by the enemies presented in **Chapter 11** of the adventure).

After returning from Dal Quor to the Sanctum in Sigil, the player characters hold a final meeting with the archmages. From there, they set off for the final confrontation, using one of Sigil's portals, taking them to the chaos of **Limbo**, close to the island formed by Vecna.

There, the player characters can move by floating across the plane, which works at the same speed as if they were walking.

VECNA: EVE OF RUIN COMPANION

LIMBO

Due to the party's interference in Dal Quor, Vecna is already waiting for them. However, he will continue to focus on his ritual while the party faces the guardians of the place, only engaging in combat when directly attacked.

During the confrontation, Vecna can create copies of himself, with less power to distract the party. The suggestion is that the statistics of the god of secrets are the same as those presented in **Vecna: Eve of Ruin** (**increasing his Intelligence to at least 26**), since the justification for him having used much of his divine power in the ritual is plausible. Unless the DM wishes to use it with the powers of a deity to offer a greater challenge to the player characters.

He can also attempt to mentally control any player character who has already attached the Hand and Eye to his body (in which case the player character must make a **DC 20 Wisdom Saving Throw** to resist being controlled by Vecna for 1d6 turns).

Vecna can also try to recover his Hand and Eye, which would increase his power. In this case, the suggestion is that he be treated as a full deity, until he has the artifacts removed from his body (via a critical strike with the Sword of Kas to remove each artifact, or if he is reduced to 0 HP by any attack other than the Sword of Kas, which will allow the party to remove the artifacts using the sword).

KEY POINTS OF THE CONFRONTATION

- **When Vecna has less than half his HP, Kas, now fused with Miska, will appear and try to corrupt the ritual, altering reality according to his vision. Things will become even more chaotic, as Kas, Vecna and the party will enter into a three-way confrontation, where the party will have to try to stop Vecna, Kas and even use the rod to imprison Miska again.**

- **If the party is at a disadvantage, and about to be defeated by Vecna, Kas will also appear, however, seeing that the chances of stopping Vecna are low, he will use the rod to remove Miska's essence from himself and fuse it with Vecna´s ritual, corrupting his creation. A way to tarnish the triumph of his former master before Kas eventually succumbs;**

- **On the other hand, if Vecna realizes that he will be defeated; he may try one last desperate measure (especially if he is in possession of the Hand and the Eye): he will use his last strength to send the energy of the ritual beyond the multiverse. He will create a second multiverse shaped according to his designs and flee to the location. In this situation, if Kas has not yet corrupted Vecna's creation with Miska's essence, he will attempt to do so at this time. If this happens, Vecna will still leave for his new multiverse in order to avoid complete defeat. In this case, the player characters will have 1 turn to defeat Vecna with the Sword of Kas before he carries out his contingency plan.**

It is suggested that the DM allows the player characters to be responsible for whatever the outcome of the adventure. This is extremely important in any adventure, especially in an adventure where the fate of the multiverse is at stake, making the Players feel satisfied with the importance of their actions.

CONCLUSION

Given the suggestions presented, the adventure can have the following outcomes:

- **Vecna is defeated by the player characters, having his ritual interrupted. The player characters (or Axackarvalos) use the Hand and Eye of Vecna to undo the effects of the ritual and revert the multiverse to its previous state. They are later met by Mordenkainen, Tasha and Alustriel, who safely remove the Hand and Eye from whoever is using them. The weakened god of secrets disappears in order to regain his strength. Kas either can flee or be destroyed, as he no longer has the power of Vecna's dreams to sustain his existence and Miska is once again imprisoned by the Rod of Seven Parts;**

- **Vecna's plan fails to reform the multiverse, but he ends up creating another multiverse in which he is sovereign, and disappears into this new unreachable reality, which may have been corrupted by Miska's essence. Kas can be destroyed because he no longer has Vecna's dreams as the source of his existence, or he can become a new enemy for the player characters to fight in the future;**

- **The player characters fail and Vecna reforms the multiverse, becoming sovereign. Only Sigil remains a safe spot, for now. Depending on Kas' attitudes, the multiverse may not be completely under Vecna's control, due to Miska's chaotic essence corrupting creation and triggering the emergence of demons and other chaotic beings that escape the control of the new master of existence.**

With the player characters' triumph, the three archmages welcome them as heroes, and all the great names in the multiverse become aware of their legendary deeds.

THE AUTHORS

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Leandro Zerbinatti de Oliveira was born in 05/02/1983 and work as a lawyer. Passionate for fantasy since young age, met the role-playing games at the age of 9, when started DMing.

His favorite D&D setting is Ravenloft, followed by Forgotten Realms and Planescape, and his longest campaign in the Demiplane of Dread lasted 15 years. During that time, contributed with fan sites and netbooks and kept a Brazilian Ravenloft fan site.

Currently, he is also a member of The Black Feather, a group of Authors (Gabriel Jansen, Pedro Wah and Rafael Castelo Branco de Oliveira Torres) dedicated to creating Ravenloft Books for DMs Guild.

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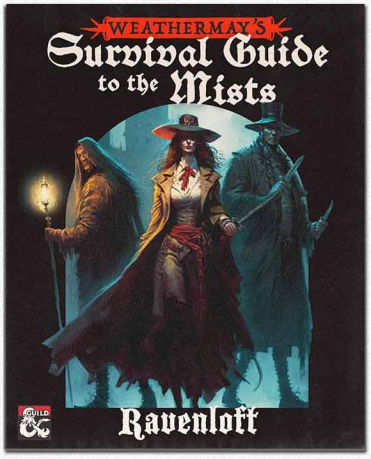
Diego Silva Lisboa is a musician and music teacher. Fanatic for videogames, strategy games and expert chess player.

Forgotten Realms was his first D&D setting, and from that point, he became a fan of the other campaign settings of Dungeons and Dragons.

OTHER BOOKS BY THE AUTHOR

AS A MEMBER OF THE BLACK FEATHER



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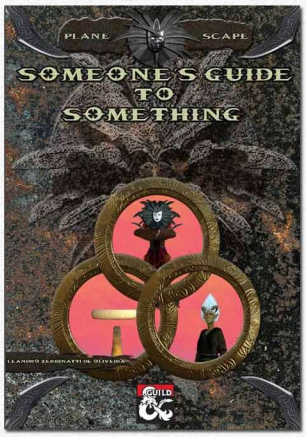

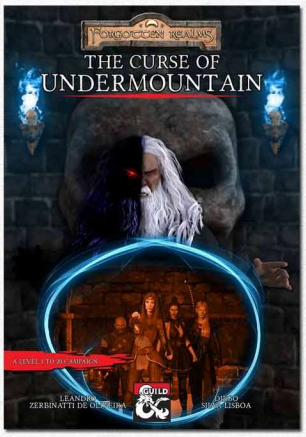

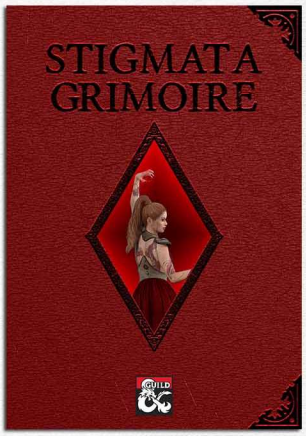

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